

Problem–Solution Fit

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Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement – Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem–Solution Fit

The **Problem–Solution Fit** for “*Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer*” focuses on identifying the challenges faced by employees and IT procurement teams when requesting standard laptops and designing an automated solution to address those challenges.

In many organizations, laptop procurement involves manual request submission, approval, verification, purchase processing, and status tracking. These activities can result in delays, repetitive work, communication gaps, and errors. By using **Flow Designer**, the laptop ordering process can be automated so that standard laptop requests are automatically routed through the required approval and fulfillment stages.

The solution aims to make laptop procurement **faster, more accurate, transparent, and easier to manage** while reducing unnecessary manual intervention by the IT team.

Purpose

- **Solve procurement delays** by automating the standard laptop request and approval process.
- **Reduce manual work** for IT and procurement teams by automatically routing requests to the appropriate approvers.
- **Improve request accuracy** by using predefined standard laptop options and required information fields.

- **Speed up order processing** through automated workflows and notifications.
- **Provide better visibility** by allowing employees and IT teams to track the status of laptop requests.
- **Reduce communication gaps** by automatically notifying users and relevant teams when the request status changes.
- **Standardize the procurement process** so that every standard laptop request follows the same defined workflow.
- **Improve user experience** by providing a simple and structured process for requesting a laptop.
- **Increase operational efficiency** by allowing IT staff to focus on exceptional or complex procurement requests instead of routine orders.
- **Understand the existing procurement process and improve it** by identifying repetitive activities, delays, and unnecessary manual steps.

Problem-Solution Fit Canvas 2.0

From customer pain to a validated solution

1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S) (CS): IT Employees, System Administrators, and Organization Managers who request and manage hardware resources.	2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS (J&P): Employees need to request standard laptops and IT hardware without manual delays. IT teams need automated ticket creation and approval routing.	3. TRIGGERS (TR): Onboarding a new employee into the organization or upgrading broken hardware for existing employees.	4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER (EM): Before: Frustrated due to slow manual email requests and lack of tracking. After: Satisfied with instant Service Catalog requests and real-time status updates.	5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS (AS): Sending manual emails to the IT support desk or filling out physical paper request forms.
6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS (CC): Limited access to administrative settings and dependency on IT support availability and strict catalog rules.	7. BEHAVIOUR (BE): Users search the ServiceNow portal, submit standard request forms, and track their ticket status online.	8. CHANNELS OF BEHAVIOUR (CH): B.1 ONLINE: ServiceNow Service Catalog portal, Automated Email Notifications, and Flow Designer workflows. B.2 OFFLINE: IT Asset warehouse physical delivery and hands-on hardware setup.	9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE (RC): Lack of automated workflows and failure to map request catalog items properly to backend assignment tables.	10. YOUR SOLUTION (SL): An automated ServiceNow Service Catalog with Integrated Flow Designer workflows that automatically routes approval tasks.

Focus on the riskiest assumption first.

Problem-Solution Fit Canvas

Canvas Element	Content for the Project
Target Customers / Users	Employees requiring standard laptops, IT support teams, IT procurement teams, managers/approvers, and asset management teams.
Customer Problem	Standard laptop procurement is often handled manually, causing delays, repetitive tasks, approval bottlenecks, data-entry errors, and difficulty tracking requests.
Existing Situation	Employees submit laptop requests through emails, forms, or service portals. IT staff manually verify the request,

Canvas Element	Content for the Project
	obtain approval, contact procurement, and update the employee about the order status.
Customer Behavior	Employees repeatedly contact IT to check request status. IT staff manually review requests, send approval emails, update records, and communicate with procurement teams.
Pain Points	Long processing time, manual approvals, repeated communication, lack of real-time status visibility, human errors, and inconsistent processing.
Frequency of Problem	The problem occurs whenever employees request or replace standard laptops, particularly in organizations with a large number of employees.
Impact of Problem	Increased workload for IT staff, delayed employee onboarding or replacement, inefficient procurement operations, and poor user experience.
Proposed Solution	Use Flow Designer to automate the standard laptop procurement workflow from request submission through approval, fulfillment, notification, and status updates.
Automation Trigger	A standard laptop request is submitted by an employee through the service/request portal.
Automated Actions	Validate request → identify approver → send approval → process approved request → notify IT/procurement → update request status → notify employee.
Customer Benefit	Faster processing, reduced manual effort, fewer errors, improved transparency, consistent workflow, and better employee experience.

Canvas Element	Content for the Project
Value Proposition	A simple and automated laptop ordering process that reduces procurement time and manual effort while providing clear visibility into request progress.
Success Measures	Reduced processing time, fewer manual interventions, faster approvals, reduced errors, improved request tracking, and higher user satisfaction.

Problem

The existing standard laptop procurement process may require several manual steps such as collecting employee information, checking the request, obtaining manager approval, contacting procurement, updating records, and informing the employee.

This creates several problems:

- Requests may take too long to process.
- IT employees spend time performing repetitive administrative tasks.
- Approval requests can be missed or delayed.
- Employees may not know the current status of their request.
- Manual data entry can result in errors.

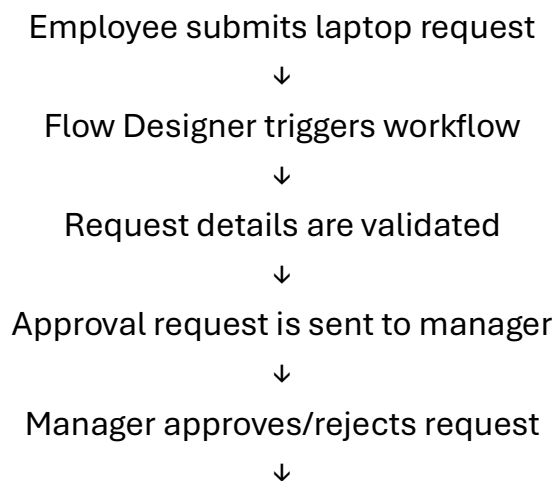
- Different IT employees may follow different procedures.
- Procurement teams may receive incomplete or delayed information.

Solution

The proposed solution is to create an **automated laptop procurement workflow using Flow Designer**.

When an employee submits a request for a standard laptop, the workflow automatically starts and performs predefined actions.

Automated Process



Approved request is forwarded for fulfilment/procurement



IT/Procurement team processes the order



Request status is automatically updated



Employee receives notification



Laptop request completed

Problem–Behaviour Fit

The system addresses the actual behaviour and difficulties of the users.

Problem / Behaviour	Automated Response
Employee manually contacts IT to request a laptop	Provide a structured request form
IT manually checks every request	Automate validation of required information

Problem / Behaviour	Automated Response
Manager approval takes time	Automatically send approval request
Employee repeatedly asks for updates	Send automatic status notifications
IT staff manually update request status	Automatically update workflow stages
Procurement receives incomplete information	Use predefined standard laptop request fields
IT staff spend time on repetitive tasks	Automate routine procurement activities

Expected Outcome

The implementation of Flow Designer is expected to transform the standard laptop ordering process from a **manual and time-consuming activity into a structured and automated workflow.**

The solution can help the organization:

1. Reduce laptop procurement processing time.
2. Minimize repetitive IT tasks.

3. Improve approval efficiency.
4. Reduce human errors.
5. Provide better request visibility.
6. Improve communication between employees, managers, IT, and procurement.
7. Create a standardized procurement procedure.
8. Improve the overall employee experience.

Problem–Solution Fit Statement

Employees need a faster and more transparent way to request standard laptops, while IT teams need to reduce repetitive manual procurement activities. Automating the laptop ordering process with Flow Designer provides a standardized workflow that manages approvals, notifications, status updates, and fulfillment efficiently.

This gives your project a clear **problem → user behavior → solution → benefit** connection, which is the main purpose of the Problem–Solution Fit canvas.